Herbarium Collections Manager

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Herbarium Collections Manager

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Provo, UT

Full time

Posted 30+ Days Ago

End Date: February 22, 2026 (2 days left to apply)

JR-7579

Why Work at BYU

As the flagship higher education institution of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, Brigham Young University (BYU) strives to be among the exceptional universities in the world. At BYU, we are devoted to our faith

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learning and growth—all situated within a beautiful and historic campus—make it hard to imagine a more inspiring place to work.

Brigham Young University strongly prefers to hire faithful members of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.

Job Description

Herbarium Collections Manager
The Bean Life Science Museum at Brigham Young University seeks a Collections Manager for the BYU Vascular Plant Herbarium. The Herbarium consists of 600,000 curated specimens which are used for 1) education of undergraduate and graduate-level students at BYU and neighboring institutions; 2) innovative research in plant conservation, taxonomy, systematics, natural history, morphology, ecology, and evolution; and 3) as a voucher repository for current research and future generations. The position's primary responsibilities are to actively manage the day-to-day operations of the Herbarium, provide meaningful mentored learning experiences to BYU undergraduates, and preserve/enhance the scientific value of this critical resource.

What you'll do in this position:

- Oversee daily herbarium operations, including specimen mounting, cataloging, curation, acquisitions, exchanges, loans, policy updates, record keeping, supply management, visitor assistance, and outreach.
- Recruit, train, supervise, and mentor student workers; provide meaningful mentored learning; supervise affiliate faculty and emeritus curator volunteers.
- Maintain proficiency in managing digital herbarium resources, including specimen databases and management systems.
- Conduct independent and collaborative collection-based research to support collection development.
- Pursue external funding and conduct fieldwork to advance collection development.
- Build and maintain relationships with faculty, agencies (BLM, NPS, NFS), conservation programs, and other stakeholders to enhance collection use and visibility.
- Participate in ongoing professional development to remain current with herbarium best practices.

What qualifies you for this role:

Required

- A firm commitment to the mission of BYU.
- A Ph.D. in Botany, Biology, or related field involving botanical specimen-based research.
- A working knowledge of basic plant taxonomy, contemporary systematics, and the ability to identify a large range of plant groups.
- Experience using diagnostic tools to authoritatively identify plant specimens.

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- Curatorial experience; familiarity with contemporary plant specimen curation methods, community standards and best practices, protocols, contemporary issues.
- Understanding of data management systems, practices, data aggregators/providers.
- Vision for maintaining and enhancing the herbarium's physical facilities, specimen holdings, online presence, and the herbarium's standing in the botanical community.
- Hands-on curation experience using collection management best practices.
- Computer skills related to specimen digitization and data management.
- A track record of effective student mentorship and personnel oversight/management.
- Interpersonal skills, ability to communicate/work with agencies and patrons, understanding permitting needs and processes.
- A track record of securing funding for research utilizing natural history collections and/or funding for herbarium-related activities/curation enhancement.
- Publication record that demonstrates proficiency in plant taxonomy, collections-based research, or related disciplines.

Application Deadline: Saturday, February 21, 2026 at 12 AM

Required Documentation - To be considered, your application must include the following materials:

- Resume
- Cover Letter
- Letter of Recommendation

What we offer in return:

In addition to our competitive pay structure, this position comes with fantastic benefits, including:

- 401k. BYU automatically contributes 8% at no cost to you. Additionally, if you contribute 5%, BYU adds an additional 4% (Rehires may qualify for different retirement plans)
- Excellent work-life balance: 13 paid holidays + 22 days paid vacation + 12 sick days, accrued annually
- Employee assistance program, available to the employee and all members of their household
- Tuition benefits for employees and eligible family members
- Access to athletic facilities
- Excellent medical/dental benefits
- Short/long-term disability benefits
- Paid parental and maternity leave
- Wellness Program
- Free on-campus parking
- Free UTA passes for employees, spouses, and qualified dependents
- Discounts at the BYU Store and for many events at BYU

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Required Documents:
All Staff positions require a resume.
Refer to the Job Posting for any additional required documents.

Members of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints must hold and be worthy to hold a current temple recommend.

Brigham Young University is an equal opportunity employer, including disability and protected veteran status.

Brigham Young University (BYU) is widely recognized not just for its world-class education, but for its deep commitment to inspired religious values. Gathered together in a Christ-centered atmosphere, BYU employees are a vital part of a community of belonging, where we value the experiences, perspectives, and talents of each individual. If you share in our devotion to faith and to excellence, we have a place for you here at BYU!

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Mission of the University

The mission of Brigham Young University — founded, supported, and guided by The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints — is to assist individuals in their quest for perfection and eternal life.

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Employment Requirements

All employees of Brigham Young University (BYU) agree to maintain the standards of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints as defined by the CES Honor Code and Dress and Grooming Standards, both on and off campus, 24 hours a day.

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